User Insights: Me@Walmart

February 2024 | Tyler Sanderson

Background

Study Goals

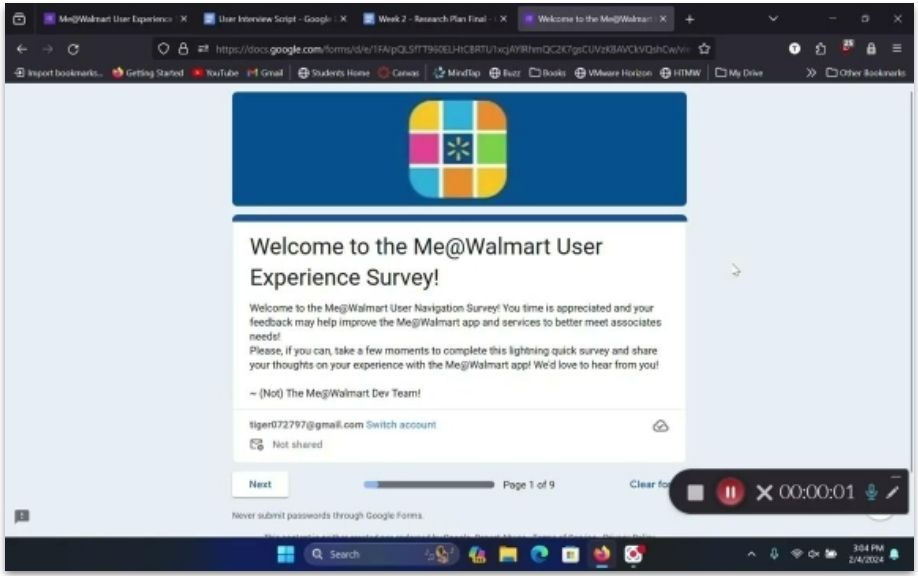
- Identify navigation/usability issues while navigating the Me@Walmart app
- Reduce friction and save time/money
- Use opportunities to help inform future Me@Walmart roadmap

Key Research Questions

- What are the pain points in navigating the app for our users?
- Does friction in navigating the app amount to a significant amount of time/money wasted?
- What changes can we make to increase user satisfaction and workflow?

Methods and Approach

Interview and Survey

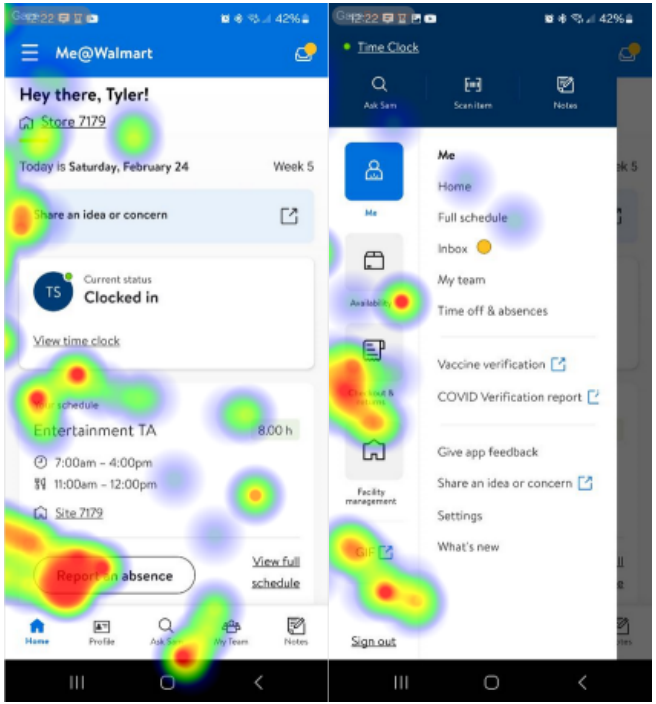


Preamble:

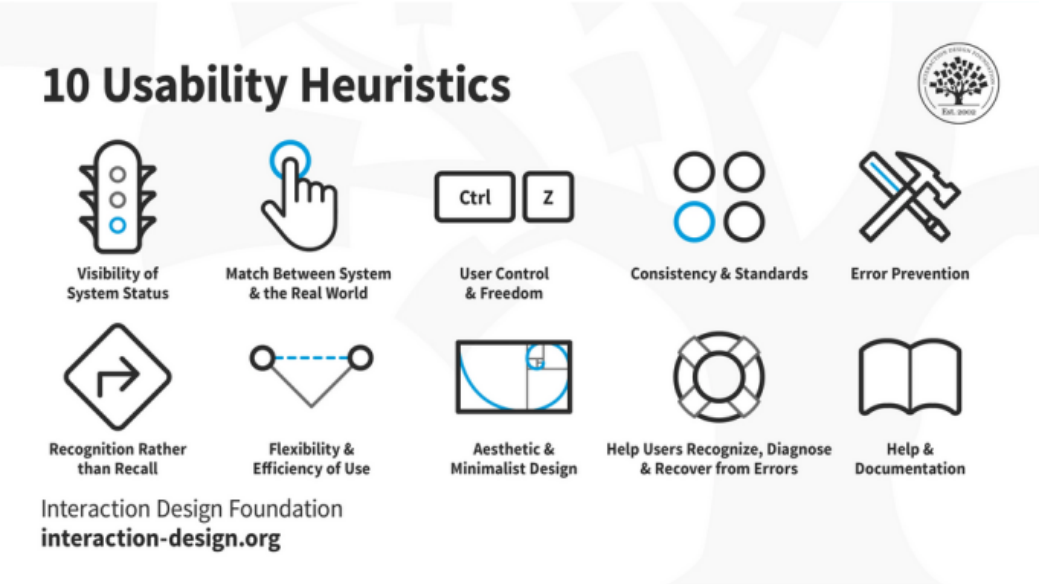
- Thank the participants for their time.
- Engage in some light opening conversation to help build rapport and put the participant at ease.
- Clarify the objectives of the session - 'Today we just want to get your thoughts on navigating the Me@Walmart app to get a better idea of what the pain points are in using the app'.
- Clarify that all findings from this interview will be kept anonymous, and that any insights shared from this session will not mention specific individuals.
- Have the user carefully read over the Research Plan and sign at the bottom/back of the page.
- Ask for permission to record the session.

Methods and Approach

Gaze Tracking



Heuristic Evaluation



Overview

Key Takeaways

WE WERE WRONG ABOUT...

- Main Issues:
  - Notion:
    - Design
    - Navigation
  - Actual:
    - Functionality
    - Performance

WE WERE RIGHT ABOUT...

- Design and Navigation can be improved to be more
  - Memorable
  - Accessible
  - Informative
- Can help prioritize development plans.

SURPRISES!

- Performance issues exemplified by :
  - Design issues
  - Navigation issues
- Improved UI could lessen perceived issues with performance to reduce demand on developers.

Key Insights

- Associates especially enjoy
  - Scheduling tools
  - All-in-one

What are the best features or aspects of the app that you like the most?

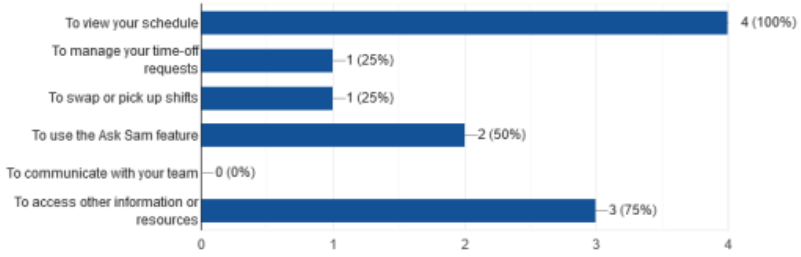
4 responses

- The profile page
- the ease of time off request
- To be able to clock into work and to use the tools for daily process
- Time Clock!

What are the main reasons you use the app for? (Select all that apply)

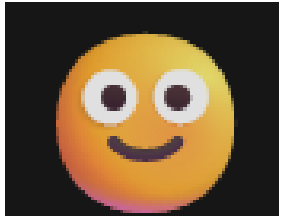
Copy

4 responses

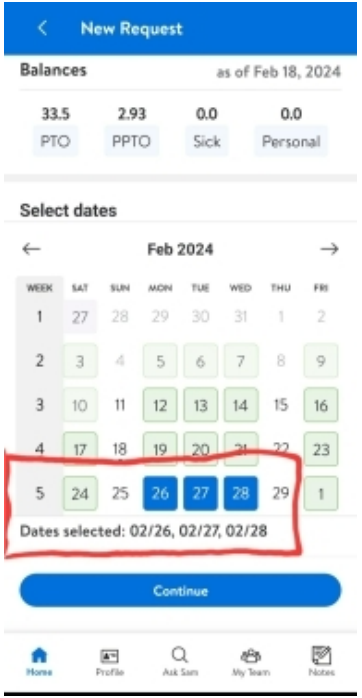


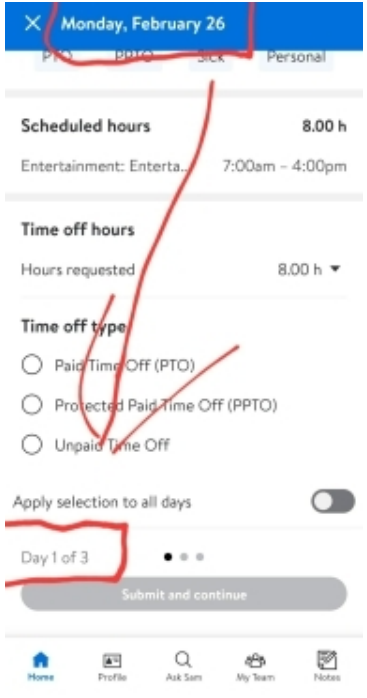
Key Insights

Users are generally satisfied with the apps navigation and design!

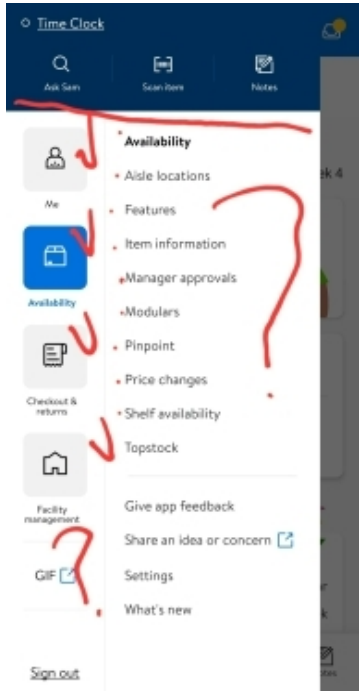


Vague/inconsistent scheduling





Lack of memorable iconography

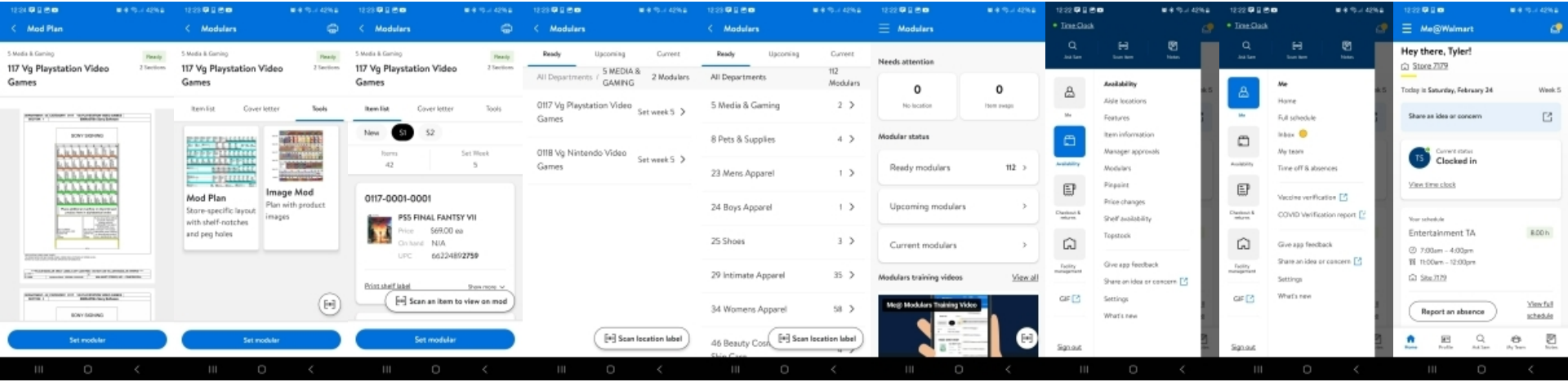


Key Insights

Tedious sub-menus

Too much reliance on back button

Navbar disappears in certain tools.



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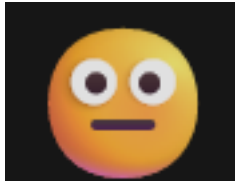
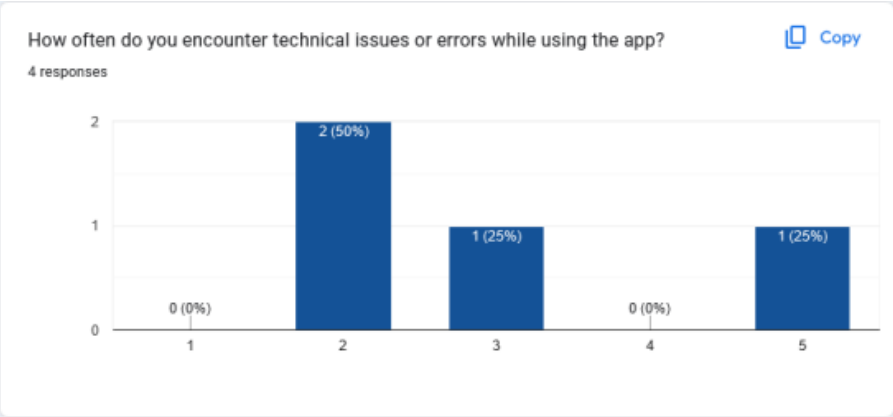
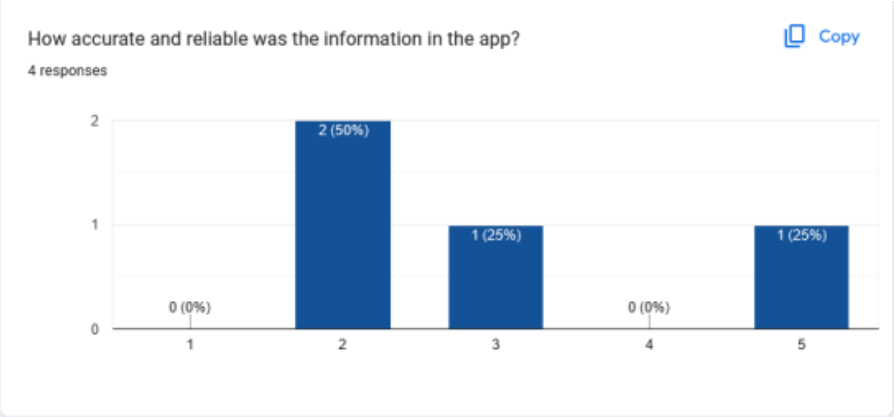


point days. A more intuitive way to return to home in some sub-spaces of the app that have you do down multiple tabs.

Key Insights

Main issue: Issues with performance…





Heuristic Evaluation - Nielsen’s 10 Heuristic Principles

Visibility of System Status

Issue:

Performance hinders feedback.

Recommendations:

Replace spinning spark logo with something more fun to keep users attention.

Match Between System and the Real World

Issue:

Lacks recognizable iconography.

Recommendations:

As suggested, add recognizable and descriptive iconography to help match internal terms to real actions.

User Control and Freedom

Issue:

Navigation is fragmented and hard to follow, sometimes obscuring other controls.

Recommendation:

Condense navigation into singular sidebar.

Heuristic Evaluation - Nielsen’s 10 Heuristic Principles

Consistency and Standards

Issue:

Doesn't necessarily follow industry standards for navigation. Lacks consistency.

Recommendations:

Better descriptors and iconography.

Error Prevention

Issue:

Some tools, such as the 'mod swaps' doesn't warn or keep history of swaps in-app.

Recommendations:

Add a history log to reprint recently swapped items.

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Issue:

Some tools lack direction or imagery depicting the goal of the tool.

Recommendation:

Add gifs, and other iconography, in a banner to the right of title cards to help explain the tools function.

Heuristic Evaluation - Nielsen’s 10 Heuristic Principles

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Issue:

Home page lacks personalization and contains too many metrics not needed for the average associate.

Recommendations:

Allow associates to pull frequently used tools to the front page and categorize metrics into a pane in the unified sidebar.

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Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Issue:

Again, overly dense home page.

Recommendations:

Should be segmented into separate panes in the apps sidebar.

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Issue:

Devices disconnect with little to help understand why.

Recommendation:

Add error messages that explain the connection issue and persist to reconnect or power cycle the device.

Heuristic Evaluation - Nielsen’s 10 Heuristic Principles

Help and Documentation

Issue:

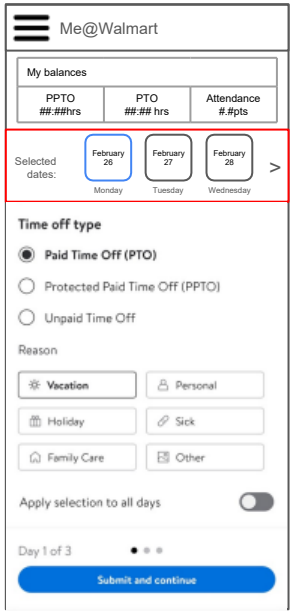
Lack of descriptors explaining tools and tasks throughout the app.

Recommendations:

Add short description of the function or tasks to be completed with said tool, as well as consistent meaningful iconography.

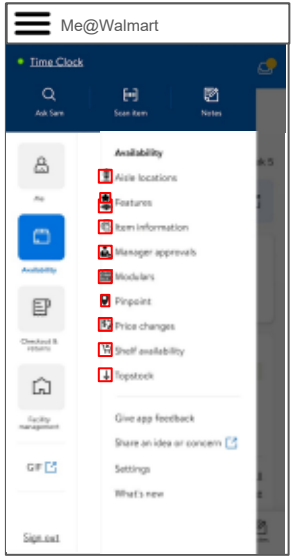
Recommendations

More clear and concise scheduling.



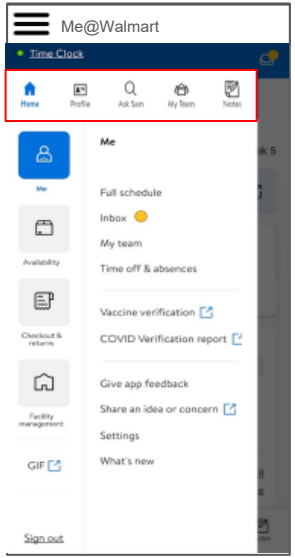
- Format key dates
- Format multi-request

Descriptive iconography



- Add memorable icons
- Add Useful descriptors

More uniform home navigation layout



- One paginated nav bar
  - Condense sidebar
  - Condense main pages

Proceed?

Further design iterations should be tested with users to compare results.

- Future research should be more comprehensive to gain proper insight into time and money wasted navigating given Walmart’s vast employee base.
- More research should be conducted after current discussed functionality issues have been addressed.

Summary

- Design and Navigation can be improved to be more
  - Memorable
  - Accessible
  - Informative
- Development priority…
  - Performance
  - Functionality
  - Reliability
- Recommendations
  - More clear and concise scheduling.
  - Descriptive iconography
  - More uniform home navigation layout

Appendix and Notes

Research Plan

Tyler Sanderson
CSC370.22746.B1 Online
January 28th, 2024

A Plan to Evaluate UX Navigation Issues in the Me@Walmart App

The Me@Walmart app aims to provide access to most of Walmart's associates daily tasks, as well as provide access to scheduling tools, mobile time clocks, and a search 'assistant' called "Ask Sam" to link and provide additional functionality. This app falls into the 'Business' category on the Google Play Store as it is aimed squarely at Walmart Associates to provide associates of Walmart with an all in one app that gives them access to most of the tools they need to do their job. However, since launching a few years ago, many users still report frustration when trying to multitask or even navigate home to access other tools, creating friction for our associates and often some loss of time (time is money…) when navigating the app. **This research plan's purpose is to give a general outline to identify navigation/usability issues while navigating the Me@Walmart app to reduce friction and save time (and money…).**

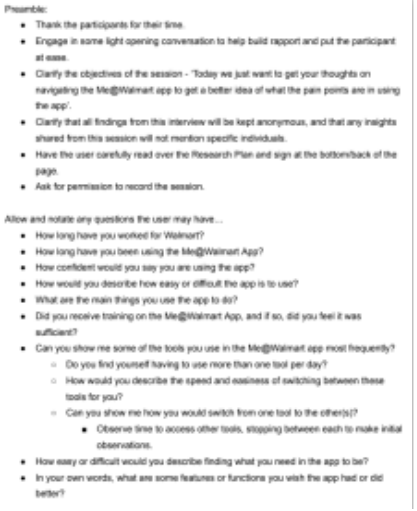
Research Methods

To do this we will be using two main research methods.

We will conduct **qualitative interviews** to gain initial insight into the navigation of the app from experienced users; after which we will administer a short **survey** to garner any additional feedback. This survey will prod users to navigate and look for and comment on discrepancies they find in intuitiveness. This should give us some insight into the navigation of the app from learned associates. We will also perform the same user testing on new users, less than 6 months, to evaluate inefficiencies in the app's intuitiveness. This should give us an idea of how we can reduce friction in picking up the app in the first place.

Given the scope of this study, we will also use a **mixed quantitative/qualitative assessment using GazeRecorder**, a free online eye tracking software. This software should allow associates to be able to interact with navigation elements while recording what their eyes 'like' to follow. This can serve as a comparison of what users may expect vs what is currently being delivered. Given the data from user interviews, we can

Interview Script



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- Have the user carefully read over the Research Plan and sign at the bottom/back of the page.
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Allow and notate any questions the user may have…

- How long have you worked for Walmart?
- How long have you been using the Me@Walmart App?
- How confident would you say you are using the app?
- How would you describe how easy or difficult the app is to use?
- What are the main things you use the app to do?
- Did you receive training on the Me@Walmart App, and if so, did you feel it was sufficient?
- Can you show me some of the tools you use in the Me@Walmart app most frequently?
  - Do you find yourself having to use more than one tool per day?
  - How would you describe the speed and easiness of switching between these tools for you?
  - Can you show me how you would switch from one tool to the other(s)?
    - Observe time to access other tools, stopping between each to make initial observations.
- How easy or difficult would you describe finding what you need in the app to be?
- In your own words, what are some features or functions you wish the app had or did better?

Interview Summary

Summary of Initial UX Navigation Interviews
Tyler Sanderson
02-05-2024

The Me@Walmart app aims to provide access to most of Walmart's associates daily tasks, as well as provide access to scheduling tools, mobile time clocks, and a search 'assistant' called "Ask Sam" to link and provide additional functionality. This app falls into the 'Business' category on the Google Play Store as it is aimed squarely at Walmart Associates to provide associates of Walmart with an all in one app that gives them access to most of the tools they need to do their job. However, since launching a few years ago, many users still report frustration when trying to multitask or even navigate home to access other tools, creating friction for our associates and often some loss of time (time is money…) when navigating the app. This research's purpose is to identify navigation/usability issues while navigating the Me@Walmart app to reduce friction and save time (and money…).

This week, verbal interviews and short surveys were administered to gain initial insight into the navigation of the app from both experienced users and new users perspectives. These users, from 3 separate departments, included two under the age of 25 and two above the age of 55. Of these participants, one was new (6 or less months) and the others were seasoned associates of 3 or more years to give a deeper perspective on intuitiveness for new users and adaptability/intuitiveness for seasoned associates.

Interviews went a little differently than anticipated, both in respect to availability and results gathered. It is still possible that more interviews are needed to gather more consistent data, but there was still some valuable information gleaned from said interviews/surveys. Generally, associates appreciate being able to view their schedules and they enjoy the idea of being able to access other tools and information from one app. Generally, and maybe most surprising, users were generally satisfied with the app's design and layout as it is now. Users expressed some frustration when switching between tools, but ultimately felt none of the frustrations in navigation were 'game breaking'. The app also got updated a bit more to reflect more opportunities for feedback, so it is possible some issues may already be aired. Maybe somewhat frustratingly, most issues simply lie in the performance and functionality of the app, rather than with the navigation and design; but users said that the poor performance and

Survey

Welcome to the Me@Walmart User Experience Survey!

Welcome to the Me@Walmart User Navigation Survey! You time is appreciated and your feedback may help improve the Me@Walmart app and services to better meet associates needs!
Please, if you can, take a few moments to complete this lightning quick survey and share your thoughts on your experience with the Me@Walmart app! We'd love to hear from you!

~ (Not) The Me@Walmart Dev Team!

[Heuristics Analysis Table]